This shows that the one-developer framework isn’t just a dream, but a reality. Rails really does compress the complexity of modern web development to a point where it’s feasible for an individual to create something amazing by themselves. Because that’s how most novel ideas start: with a single individual taking it as far as they can before needing others to help go further. And with Rails, you can take it very far indeed.

Think of all the incredible applications that run the Internet with Rails as their backbone, like Shopify, GitHub, Procore, Cookpad, Intercom, Fleetio, Instacart, Gusto, Zendesk, Coinbase, and many, many more. My own life’s work, Basecamp, the original Rails application, is still going strong, as is HEY, my email service. And all of it is built on Rails! That’s all the evidence you’d ever need that Rails can take you from HELLO WORLD to IPO, as we say on the homepage.

That’s an ambitious mission because Rails is an ambitious framework. We’re tackling the entire web problem—not just a database mapper, a URL router, or a templating language—all of it, all at once, and so much more. Rails is the original full-stack framework, and as the web has evolved in the two decades since its release, we continued to keep up with the new problems and solutions that have arisen.

Many alternatives to Rails have come and gone over the years. Many more will. But Ruby on Rails remains. So you’ve made the right decision buying this book and inviting Sam and Dave to help you learn this incredible framework. I hope you have as much fun as I did discovering Ruby and riding Rails!

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